

Next-generation mobile networks have revolutionised the way we view television programming and listen to music. In fact, users can now get all sorts of information - the latest sports updates, stock quotes, business listings, driving directions, movie timings, and weather conditions. People can also book travel tickets, pay bills and shop using their cell phone. For instance, through SMS, people can search the Web for stores and businesses in the neighbourhood. Popular television shows such as *Indian Idol* encourage viewers to vote for their chosen performer through SMS. And, news channels ask viewers to send in their questions or replies on various issues through SMS.

To give you a recent example, SMS text-messaging company KAPOW! announced the trial of the UK's first SMS railway-commuter club. Commuters will aim to notify *en masse* other commuters of cancellations and delays long before the railway companies are able to pass on this information.



Mobile phones have become an inseparable part of present day society

Our dependency on cell phones has reached an extent that we can't imagine life without them. When was the last time you referred to a paper phone book to call an acquaintance?

Cell phone theft has become an everyday affair. A new age crime, cell phone theft is an ever-increasing problem. Here's a way of rendering a lost or stolen mobile useless to thieves. To check your mobile phone's serial number, key in the following on your phone:

* # 0 6 #

A fifteen digit code will appear on the screen. This is unique to your handset - note it down. If your mobile is stolen, you can phone your service provider and give them this code. They will then be able